AWESOME CYBER SECURITY HEAVEN · REALM DOSSIER · 2026 EDITION

The Cartographers

Recon, OSINT & Attack-Surface Mapping Tools

45	307,234	89%	36
FREE TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

45 tools · ← Back to the main list · Data verified **2026-10-22** (re-verified monthly)

CURATOR'S NOTES

The mapping layer of offensive work — subdomain enumeration, certificate transparency, DNS archaeology and attack-surface diffing. The projectdiscovery suite lives here, alongside the classic recon one-liners every bounty hunter memorizes.

MAINTENANCE SNAPSHOT (2026-10-22)

- Active in the last 30 days: 25 of 40 tracked GitHub repos (63%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 12+ months, still listed): dnstwist, assetfinder, VHostScan, ike-scan
- Earliest entries: dnsrecon (2010), theHarvester (2011), ike-scan (2013)

Part of **Awesome Cyber Security Heaven** — 500 curated free tools across 14 realms

FLAGSHIP PICKS — THE HEAVYWEIGHTS

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	WHAT IT DOES
sherlock	94.7k	2018	2026-10-22 ✅	Hunt down social media accounts by username across social networks
GHunt	19.7k	2020	2026-04-10	🕵️ Offensive Google framework.
theHarvester	18k	2011	2026-10-20 ✅	E-mails, subdomains and names Harvester - OSINT
katana	17.7k	2021	2026-10-22 ✅	A next-generation crawling and spidering framework.
ffuf	16.9k	2018	2026-09-26 ✅	Fast web fuzzer written in Go
Amass	15.4k	2018	2026-07-19	In-depth attack surface mapping and asset discovery

FULL INVENTORY — 45 CURATED TOOLS

ranked by GitHub adoption · 2026-10-22 census · non-GitHub entries listed last

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
sherlock	94.7k	2018	2026-10-22 ✅	— hunt one username across 400+ social networks; people-OSINT in seconds. Used by OSINT investigators checking username presence across hundreds of platforms; the standard free account-discovery tool.
GHunt	19.7k	2020	2026-04-10	— investigate a Google account's public footprint (photos, reviews, services) from an email — for authorized OSINT; respect ToS. Used by OSINT investigators profiling Google accounts from public artifacts; the open alternative to commercial people-intel tools. (AGPL-3.0)

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
theHarvester	18k	2011	2026-10-20 ✅	— emails, subdomains, hosts and names from public sources — the OSINT starter kit. Used by pentesters in the recon phase harvesting emails, names and subdomains; the veteran free OSINT gatherer. (GPL-2.0)
katana	17.7k	2021	2026-10-22 ✅	— next-generation crawler with headless-browser support for JavaScript-heavy applications. Used by bug hunters and pentesters crawling modern JS-heavy apps; the ProjectDiscovery successor to legacy crawlers in recon pipelines.
ffuf	16.9k	2018	2026-09-26 ✅	— the fast web fuzzer everyone uses for content, parameter and vhost discovery. Used by web pentesters as the de facto standard free web fuzzer.
Amass	15.4k	2018	2026-07-19	— deep attack-surface mapping: DNS enumeration, scraping, archives, APIs and permutations in one OWASP project. Used by recon teams and bug bounty hunters for deep subdomain enumeration; the OWASP project that anchors most serious attack-surface pipelines.
subfinder	14.6k	2018	2026-10-21 ✅	— fast, passive subdomain discovery from dozens of sources; the standard first command of any engagement. Used by bug bounty hunters for fast passive subdomain discovery; the ProjectDiscovery staple of recon automation.
gobuster	14.2k	2014	2026-10-15 ✅	— the classic directory/DNS/vhost buster in Go; the tool feroxbuster and ffuf grew from. Used by pentesters for directory, DNS and vhost brute-forcing; the veteran free alternative to commercial content scanners.
bbot	10.7k	2022	2026-10-22 ✅	— recursive, modular OSINT/scanning framework — spider the whole attack surface with one command. Used by attack-surface teams running modular, recursive recon; the open-source framework rivaling commercial ASM discovery. (AGPL-3.0)
httpx	10.5k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	— the HTTP prober: filter thousands of hosts by status, title, tech, CDN and TLS in a single pass. Used by bug bounty hunters triaging alive hosts from mass subdomain lists; the ProjectDiscovery prober in nearly every recon pipeline.
feroxbuster	8.1k	2020	2026-10-15 ✅	— fast recursive content discovery in Rust with great heuristics and recursion handling. Used by web pentesters for fast recursive content discovery; the Rust-based favorite alongside ffuf and gobuster.
wfuzz	6.6k	2014	2026-01-21	— the web fuzzer that replaces any part of a request with a payload — parameters, headers, paths, verbs. Used by web pentesters fuzzing any part of an HTTP request; the classic free fuzzer predating ffuf. (GPL-2.0)
naabu	6.3k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	— fast, SYN-based port scanner built to be pipelined, not watched. Used by bug bounty hunters for SYN port scanning; the ProjectDiscovery port scanner in recon pipelines.
recon-ng	6k	2019	2026-10-05 ✅	— the other recon framework: fully modular, database-backed web recon with a Metasploit-style console. Used by pentesters running structured recon workflows; the Metasploit-style framework for the recon phase. (GPL-3.0)
EyeWitness	5.9k	2014	2026-01-05	— screenshots, headers and key info from web servers during authorized recon passes. Used by pentesters screenshotting and triaging web servers in bulk; the standard free recon triage tool. (GPL-3.0)
dnstwist	5.8k	2015	2025-04-15 ⏳	— detect typosquat, homograph and permutation lookalikes of your domain — a must for phishing defense and brand monitoring. Used by brand-protection and anti-phishing teams hunting lookalike domains; the open-source alternative to commercial domain-monitoring services.
gau	5.1k	2020	2026-10-12 ✅	— fetch URLs indexed by AlienVault OTX, the Wayback Machine and Common Crawl. Used by bug bounty hunters pulling all known URLs from public archives; the free fetcher that seeds most recon pipelines.
assetfinder	3.7k	2019	2024-06-07 ⏳	— passive subdomain discovery that polls a dozen public sources and prints a clean list — no keys needed; quiet upstream, still the classic. Used by bug bounty hunters for quick passive subdomain finds; the lightweight staple of recon one-liners.

TOOL	★ STARS	CREATED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE / TIER
massdns	3.7k	2016	2026-09-27 ✅	— high-performance DNS stub resolver for bulk subdomain brute-forcing at scale. Used by recon pipelines resolving millions of subdomains; the free high-performance resolver no commercial tool beats on price. (GPL-3.0)
ParamSpider	3.2k	2020	2026-03-07	— mines archived URLs and parameters from the Wayback Machine to seed injection testing. Used by bug hunters mining hidden parameters from archives; the free parameter-mining step before injection testing.
dnsrecon	3.1k	2010	2026-10-12 ✅	— DNS enumeration workhorse: records, zone transfers, reverse lookups and subdomain brute-forcing. Used by pentesters enumerating DNS records and zone transfers; the veteran free DNS enumeration tool. (GPL-2.0)
FinalRecon	3k	2019	2026-06-01	— all-in-one web recon: headers, whois, SSL, DNS, subdomains, ports, directories and traceroute in a single modular run. Used by pentesters running a fast first-pass recon sweep before deep-dive tooling; the modular Python alternative to juggling ten single-purpose scripts. (MIT)
dnsx	2.9k	2020	2026-10-21 ✅	— multi-purpose DNS toolkit: reverse lookups, wildcard detection, response filtering. Used by recon teams for DNS querying and reverse lookups at scale; the ProjectDiscovery DNS multitool.
waymore	2.8k	2022	2026-06-11	— pull way more from the Wayback Machine: full responses, not just URLs. Used by bug hunters mining the Wayback Machine deeply for hidden endpoints and parameters; the successor to gau for archive URL intel.
CloakQuest3r	2.3k	2023	2026-01-06	— unmask the real origin IP behind Cloudflare and similar CDNs using historical DNS, SSL certificates and subdomain correlation. Used by security teams verifying true origin exposure before hardening allowlists; the open-source alternative to commercial CDN-unmasking services. (MIT)
JARM	1.3k	2020	2026-08-13	— active TLS server fingerprint: identifies servers behind CDNs from their handshake behavior. Used by CTI analysts identifying TLS server infrastructure; the free passive fingerprint actively used in threat research. (BSD-3-Clause)
VHostScan	1.3k	2017	2025-08-18 ⏳	— enumerates virtual hosts on a shared IP — discover the neighbors your target lives with. Used by pentesters discovering virtual hosts on shared infrastructure; a focused free tool for shared-hosting engagements. (GPL-3.0)
Awesome Censys Queries	1.2k	2022	2026-07-20	— a curated corpus of Censys search queries for internet-wide recon. Used by CTI analysts running certified Censys hunting; the community cookbook for asset-search queries. (CC-BY-4.0, curated list)
Recog	796	2013	2026-10-12 ✅	— the fingerprint database behind Metasploit and Nexpose: service banners mapped to OS and product families. Used by fingerprinting tool maintainers for service identification; the open database behind Metasploit and Rapid7 tooling. (BSD-3-Clause)
ARL-Next	469	2026	2026-10-22 ✅	— attack-surface reconnaissance platform combining subdomain enumeration, port scanning, fingerprinting and a nuclei PoC pipeline with task scheduling. Used by attack-surface teams running scheduled recon over large asset lists; the actively maintained continuation of the ARL recon platform. (GPL-3.0)
ike-scan	423	2013	2024-09-15 ⏳	— IKE/IPsec security auditing: fingerprint VPN gateways and enumerate transform proposals. Used by network pentesters fingerprinting IKE/VPN endpoints; the classic free IPSec scanner. (GPL-2.0)
nerva	370	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— high-performance service fingerprinting CLI identifying 170+ protocols on TCP, UDP and SCTP with safe misconfiguration checks. Used by recon teams fingerprinting services at scale without credentials; Praetorian's open-source protocol identification engine. (Apache-2.0)
DorkEye	154	2025	2026-10-21 ✅	— OSINT dork pipeline: email, subdomain and people discovery through structured query automation. Used by bug hunters running Google dorks via SearX; the free web-based dork launcher. (MIT)

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AtDork	49	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— multi-engine Google-dork scraper with categorized GHDB output for authorized reconnaissance. Used by bug bounty hunters automating Google dorking for exposed targets; the free dork engine for recon. (MIT)
BloodRecon	22	2025	2026-10-16 ✅	— automated recon pipeline that chains subdomain discovery, JavaScript endpoint extraction and a nuclei handoff with Telegram notifications. Used by bug bounty hunters automating the recon-to-scan handoff; the one-command recon pipeline for bounty workflows. (MIT)
Dork	10	2026	2026-08-21	— curated Google-dork payload library for cloud, AI, SaaS and IoT reconnaissance. Used by recon teams pulling tested dorks per target class; the categorized dork corpus for scoped discovery. (MIT)
DorkCraft	9	2026	2026-10-12 ✅	— rule-based dork generator: translates intent into search queries deterministically, zero AI, zero outbound calls. Used by recon practitioners bulk-running dork queries; the open dork-scanning alternative to paid search tooling. (MIT)
recon	5	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— passive domain-intelligence framework with per-phase structured output for tech-stack and email-security audits. Used by auditors assembling passive domain profiles without touching the target; the structured-output recon framework for assessment prep. (Apache-2.0)
Dorker	—	2026	2026-10-22 ✅	— cross-platform multi-engine Google-dork CLI with per-engine query translation and scoped validation. Used by OSINT hunters running one dork across multiple engines; the dork translator for cross-engine reconnaissance. (Apache-2.0)
DorkIntel	—	2026	2026-10-21 ✅	— client-side library of 162 categorized Google dorks for intelligence dashboards. Used by OSINT tool builders embedding dork queries in dashboards; the embeddable dork dataset for client-side intel tooling. (MIT)
CeWL	—	—	—	— custom wordlist generation by spidering target sites — the content-aware dictionary for authorized assessments. Used by pentesters building custom wordlists from target sites for password audits; the standard free custom-wordlist spider. (GPL-3.0)
DNSdumpster	—	—	—	— visual DNS reconnaissance: subdomains, MX, and infrastructure maps from public records. Used by beginners and quick-recon tasks for visual DNS mapping; the free web tool that kickstarts attack-surface discovery. (free service)
Maltego CE	—	—	—	— the standard OSINT graphing tool for entity-relationship investigation; free community edition. Used by OSINT analysts and investigators for link analysis; the free community edition of the commercial Maltego. (free tier)
Merklemap	—	—	—	— subdomain discovery through certificate-transparency logs; billions of entries, searchable. Used by recon teams searching Certificate Transparency for subdomains; the free CT search joining crt.sh-style tooling. (free service)
WiGLE	—	—	—	— the wireless network mapping archive; queries by BSSID/SSID across millions of observed networks. Used by wireless OSINT researchers mapping networks worldwide; the free wardriving database with no commercial equal. (free service)